authorized soldiers to use live ammunition against rioters who shot fireworks. Ultimately, the synagogue attack even helped to bring down the Israeli government.

Yet in hindsight it was the peak of what the Israeli press dubbed the “silent intifada”, or Palestinian uprising. The violence did not stop completely: two policemen were stabbed in the Old City and a young girl was seriously injured by a firebomb. But there was no further escalation. The media eagerly turned to coverage of the upcoming election, and talk of an intifada all but disappeared. The eleven fatalities of the violence, and the countless Palestinians swept up in the ensuing crackdown, barely elicited a mention during the three-month campaign. It was, if anything, the forgotten intifada—until it happened again.

The winter of 2014 would turn out to be a preview of a bloodier and more sustained wave of violence the following year, a glimpse of how a conflict thought to be manageable could still erupt. More importantly, it offered a glimpse at the fault lines running under Israel’s supposedly undivided capital.

Jerusalem

The early Zionists did not care much for the holy city. “When I remember thee in days to come, O Jerusalem, it will not be with pleasure,” Theodor Herzl wrote in his diary in 1898, after his only known visit to Palestine. He lamented the “musty deposits of 2,000 years of inhumanity, intolerance and foulness” found in the city’s “reeking alleys”. When he stood before the Western Wall, he felt no emotion—save for disgust at the “hideous, miserable, scrambling beggary” all around. Shai Agnon, the Austrian-born writer who would win a Nobel Prize for his work in Hebrew, was repulsed by the city’s Jewish residents. “When you approach one of them he flees from you as if he has seen a ghost,” he wrote. (Many of them were Orthodox Jews with little interest in political Zionism.)

Instead they lavished their attentions on Jaffa (and Tel Aviv, founded in 1909 on the dunes north of the ancient port), and on rural parts of Palestine. It was there, away from the stifling religious atmosphere of Jerusalem, that the pioneers believed they could craft a new Hebrew identity: secular, cultured, agrarian, with Jewish nationalism taking the place of Jewish dogma. They also viewed Jerusalem as a political problem. Herzl feared